

# Leo J. Chung

SCIENTIST · EDUCATOR · ART, MUSIC & SPORT · NEUROSCIENCE, UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

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## EDUCATION

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| Sep 2024 – May 2028 | <b>The University of British Columbia</b><br>BSc – Neuroscience              |
| Sep 2023 – Jun 2024 | <b>University of Washington</b><br>BSc – Neurobiology & Neurosciences        |
| 2018 – 2023         | <b>St. George's School</b><br>High School Diploma – Honours with Distinction |

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## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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| Aug 2025 – May 2026 | <b>Exploring the role of autism-associated BAF complex variants in social communication in neonatal mice</b><br>Ciernia Lab, DMCBH · Simons Foundation SURFiN Fellowship<br>The BAF complex remodels chromatin, and variants in it sit among the most strongly autism-associated mutations known. This project asked what those variants do to social communication in mouse pups — measured through ultrasonic vocalizations, the calls a pup directs at its mother an octave above anything a person can hear. |
| May 2025 – May 2026 | <b>Neuroaesthetics: Your Brain on Art</b><br>ASTU 400E · UBC Centre for Community Engaged Learning<br>A full-credit undergraduate seminar on what happens in the brain when people make art, and when they look at it. I co-created and co-taught it with Betty Bao, under faculty sponsor Dr.                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Apr 2025 – Sep 2025 | <b>The role of inflammatory bowel disease in the neurological immune response to the development of Alzheimer's disease pathology in mice</b><br>Ciernia Lab, DMCBH · SBME Synergy Summer Studentship<br>Whether chronic gut inflammation changes the brain's immune response as Alzheimer's pathology develops — one arm of the lab's broader work on the gut–brain axis. The readout was immunohistochemical: staining for microglia, the brain's resident immune cells, against amyloid-beta plaques.         |
| Jul 2024 – Apr 2025 | <b>Impact of human IBD microbiota on hypothalamic gene expression and steroid regulation in the mouse brain</b><br>Ciernia Lab, DMCBH · SBME Synergy Summer Studentship<br>Human IBD microbiota transplanted into mice, with the readout taken in the hypothalamus — which genes shift, and what happens to steroid regulation. My first project in the lab.                                                                                                                                                     |

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## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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| May 2026 – present | <b>Research &amp; Development Intern</b><br>STEMCELL Technologies · Vancouver, BC · UBC Co-op<br>Product licensing, testing and integration.                                        |
| Jun 2026 – present | <b>Research Data Analyst</b><br>Johns Hopkins University · Baltimore, MD · Hybrid<br>Data analysis and statistics for the Moss Lab, Department of Psychological and Brain Sciences. |

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| Aug 2025 – May 2026 | <b>Undergraduate Research Fellow in Neuroscience</b><br>Simons Foundation · Ciernia Lab, DMCBH<br>Shenoy Undergraduate Research Fellowship in Neuroscience (SURFiN).                                                                                                           |
| Jun 2024 – May 2026 | <b>Undergraduate Researcher</b><br>Djavad Mowafaghian Centre for Brain Health · Ciernia Lab<br>Supported by the School of Biomedical Engineering Synergy Summer Studentship and the UBC Work Learn Program; the post transitioned into the Simons Foundation fellowship above. |
| Jun 2021 – Jun 2025 | <b>Handyman Mechanic</b><br>Handyman Services · South Vancouver                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Sep 2023 – Jun 2024 | <b>Community Advisory Board Member</b><br>University of Washington – Housing & Food Services · Housing & Food Services · UW Seattle                                                                                                                                            |
| Sep 2023 – Mar 2024 | <b>Concession Worker</b><br>University of Washington – Housing & Food Services · Frost Bite · UW Seattle · On-call                                                                                                                                                             |
| Mar 2021 – Oct 2021 | <b>Pharmacy Assistant</b><br>Shoppers Drug Mart · South Vancouver                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

## TEACHING & EDUCATION

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| Jul 2025 – May 2026 | <b>Co-creator &amp; instructor — ASTU_V 400E, Neuroaesthetics: Your Brain on Art</b><br>UBC Centre for Community Engaged Learning · Student-Directed Seminar<br>Co-proposed with Betty Bao under faculty sponsor Dr. Steven Barnes, and taught for credit in Winter Term 2 of 2025/26. |
| May 2026 – present  | <b>Med-Tech Education Research Assistant</b><br>Si-Lab · UBC School of Audiology & Speech Sciences<br>Research on how simulation-based teaching changes what clinical students know and how confident they feel — didactic lecture against role-play and high-fidelity simulation.     |
| Feb 2026 – Mar 2026 | <b>Research Adjudicator — Multidisciplinary Undergraduate Research Conference</b><br>UBC Centre for Community Engaged Learning<br>Judged undergraduate research presentations across disciplines.                                                                                      |
| Oct 2024 – Apr 2025 | <b>Research Adjudicator &amp; Mentor</b><br>International Youth Neuroscience Association<br>Reviewed student research and mentored high-school and early-undergraduate students on getting started in neuroscience.                                                                    |
| Mar 2021 – Aug 2023 | <b>Peer Tutor</b><br>Youth Initiative Vancouver<br>Two and a half years of one-to-one tutoring.                                                                                                                                                                                        |

## SELECTED COVERAGE

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| Sep 2025 | <b>Student Scientists Shine at Synergy Undergraduate Research Day</b><br>UBC School of Biomedical Engineering<br><a href="https://bme.ubc.ca/student-scientists-shine-at-synergy-undergraduate-research-day/">bme.ubc.ca/student-scientists-shine-at-synergy-undergraduate-research-day/</a> |
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| Nov 2025 | <b>7 New Student Directed Seminars in Arts</b><br>UBC Faculty of Arts<br><a href="https://arts.ubc.ca/news/7-new-student-directed-seminars-in-arts/">arts.ubc.ca/news/7-new-student-directed-seminars-in-arts/</a>                                                                                                                   |
| Sep 2025 | <b>Simons Foundation Announces Latest Class of SURFiN Fellows</b><br>Simons Foundation · 2025–26 cohort, 84 fellows<br><a href="https://simonsfoundation.org/2025/09/29/simons-foundation-announces-latest-class-of-surfin-fellows/">simonsfoundation.org/2025/09/29/simons-foundation-announces-latest-class-of-surfin-fellows/</a> |
| Sep 2025 | <b>SBME Synergy 2025 Undergraduate Summer Research Highlights</b><br>Djavad Mowafaghian Centre for Brain Health<br><a href="https://centreforbrainhealth.ca/news/sbme-synergy-2025-undergraduate-summer-research-highlights/">centreforbrainhealth.ca/news/sbme-synergy-2025-undergraduate-summer-research-highlights/</a>           |

#### SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

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| 2025 –    | <b>DMCBH Trainee Committee Representative</b><br>Vancouver Coastal Health Research Institute   |
| 2026 –    | <b>Abdul Ladha Science Centre Supervisor</b><br>Science Undergraduate Society, UBC             |
| 2024 –    | <b>Child Care Emergency Department Worker</b><br>BC Children's Hospital, Vancouver             |
| 2025 – 26 | <b>Academic Portfolio Director</b><br>UBC Neuroscience Association                             |
| 2025 – 26 | <b>Career &amp; Professional Development Coordinator</b><br>Science Undergraduate Society, UBC |
| 2024 – 25 | <b>Academic Committee Member</b><br>UBC Neuroscience Association                               |
| 2020 – 23 | <b>Web Content Producer</b><br>VCBC JCKidz                                                     |

#### SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

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| Bench & imaging      | Organoids, Confocal microscopy, Molecular biology, Wet chemistry                                                                          |
| Animal research      | Mouse handling <sup>†</sup> , CCAC laboratory rodent ethics <sup>†</sup> , Behavioral assays                                              |
| Safety & compliance  | Biosafety permit <sup>†</sup> , Chemical safety <sup>†</sup> , Hazardous waste management <sup>†</sup> , Food safety — CP-FS <sup>†</sup> |
| Research practice    | Research ethics, Project planning, Data cleaning & merging, Scientific writing                                                            |
| Teaching & outreach  | Curriculum design, Community outreach, Event planning, Mentorship                                                                         |
| Working with people  | Collaborative leadership, Project management, Teamwork, Customer experience                                                               |
| † formally certified |                                                                                                                                           |